

Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

CONTENT

- Let's Start! • Let's Explore! • Let's Practice! • Extension Activity • Target Words • Learning Points



Let's Start!

Let's review!



Learning Outcome

Analyze issues relating to different topics and their solution in written and spoken situations according to work and social contexts.

Can Do Statements

- I can request or report facts about events or actions.
- I can talk about my work responsibilities.
- I can talk about solving problems.

Ask your partner:

- Have you ever felt like you were in over your head? What happened?
- What are some things you can do when you are in an overwhelming situation?





Let's Explore!

Kristi and Adam **debrief*** after their first week.

* "To debrief" means to talk in detail about work that has been done.



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

- Adam:** Wow, I'm glad that week is over! I hope that your week was better than mine.
- Kristi:** It was good! I reckon that you've had a hard week. What happened?
- Adam:** Well, apparently my team told my editor that I wasn't pulling my weight. I don't understand! I have been working hard ever since I got here. I suppose I've been a bit slow, but I've been trying hard to pick things up! I've done everything that I've been asked to do. The people I work with haven't been particularly helpful either. And the training that I received wasn't great. No one showed me how to order paper.
- Kristi:** You mustn't blame your coworkers. I understand that you've been put with one of the best teams. Sometimes you ought to be more proactive. Maybe you need to take the initiative and ask what you can do instead of waiting for people to tell you what to do. I imagine you've worked hard at the tasks you've been given, but you should do more than just the minimum. You've got to work to pitch in wherever you can.
- Adam:** You're right. My editor asked whether I thought my job was a good fit for me or not. I promised him that I would work harder. But how about you? How was your second week?
- Kristi:** Great! My editor asked if I wanted to work on editing a whole book. It's a lot of responsibility, but I think I should show some confidence and take on the challenge.
- Adam:** Of course! You've got to accept more responsibility when it's offered to you. Congratulations! You must have really impressed him.
- Kristi:** Thanks! I just don't want to get in over my head.





Let's Practice!

What words do Adam and Kristi use when talking about work?

Instruction: Draw a line to match the words in Column A with their definition in Column B.

COLUMN A

1. to reckon
2. to pull your weight
3. to pick up
4. training
5. to pitch in
6. to get in over one's head

COLUMN B

- a. do your part
- b. think; believe
- c. learn something quickly
- d. contribute toward a general effort
- e. the process of learning skills you need
- f. be involved in a difficult situation



Let's Practice!

Adam adds in some more details.

Instructions: Read the clues on the left. Check the correct box in the table. There is only one answer per sentence.

	Adverbial clause of time	Adverbial clause of place	Defining clause
I hope that your week was better than mine.			
I have been working hard ever since I got here.			
I've done everything that I've been asked to do.			
The people who I work with haven't been particularly helpful either.			
The training that I received wasn't great.			
You've got to offer to pitch in wherever you can.			





Extension Activity

Give advice to a partner.

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- On a piece of paper, write down five events that made your week a very bad one at work or school. (You can invent those events, or you can use Adam's bad week).
- Have a conversation with a partner and tell them about your bad week at work.
- Ask your partner for some suggestions on how to make next week better.
- Switch roles. Listen to your partner talk about their bad week and give them some advice.

Self-Assessment

Yes

No

I describe a bad week at work.

☐ ☐

I talk about problems at work.

☐ ☐

I ask for suggestions from a partner.

☐ ☐

I give advice and suggestions to a partner.

☐ ☐


Target Words

- to reckon** (verb): to think or believe
e.g. I reckon that you've had a hard week.
- to pull your weight** (expression): to do your part
e.g. My team told my editor that I wasn't pulling my weight.
- to pick up** (verb): to learn something quickly and easily
e.g. I suppose I've been a bit slow, but I've been trying hard to pick things up!
- training** (noun): the process of learning the skills you need to do a particular job or activity
e.g. The training that I received wasn't great.
- to pitch in** (verb): to start to do something as part of a group, especially something helpful
e.g. You've got to offer to pitch in wherever you can.
- to get in over one's head** (expression): to get involved in a difficult situation that is not easy to get out of
e.g. I just don't want to get in over my head.





Learning Points

Present Perfect with Report or Comment Phrases

You use the Present Perfect tense to talk about past events that have a connection to the future.

You can use the Present Perfect tense with other verbs to report or comment on events.

You use verbs such as *reckon*, *understand*, *suppose*, *guess* and *imagine* to communicate your thoughts and to report about something that happened in the past and has a connection to the present.

For example:

*I **understand (that) you have done** a lot of editing in previous jobs.*

Examples:

- *I reckon that you've had a hard week.*
- *I suppose I've been a bit slow, but I've been trying hard to pick things up!*
- *I understand that you've been put with one of the best teams.*
- *I imagine you've worked hard at the tasks you've been given, but you should do more than just the minimum.*

Relative Clauses and Adverbial Phrases

You use relative clauses to make your writing and speaking more detailed and sophisticated. A defining clause gives essential information about a noun. A non-defining clause gives additional information about a noun.

In relative clauses, you use *who* for people, *that* or *which* for things, *when* with time and *where* with places.

Defining Clause:

People **who talk too much** annoy me a lot.

Without the clause "who talk too much", the meaning of the sentence changes:
People annoy me a lot.

Non-defining Clause:

My younger sister, **who is really shy**, rarely speaks to anyone.

Without the clause "who is really shy" the main idea of the sentence stays the same. The non-defining clause is separated from the rest of the sentence with commas.

An adverbial clause is a phrase which works like an adverb. There are several different kinds





Learning Points

of adverbial clauses:

Adverbial Clauses of Time

An adverbial clause of time indicates when something happens or how often. It begins with one of the following subordinating conjunctions: *after, as, as long as, as soon as, before, no sooner than, since, until, when, or while*.

Adverbial Clauses of Place

An adverbial clause of place indicates where something happens. It usually starts with a preposition (e.g., *in, on, near*) or one of the following subordinating conjunctions: *anywhere, everywhere, where, or wherever*.

Adverbial Clauses of Manner

An adverbial clause of manner indicates how something happens. It often starts with one of the following subordinating conjunctions: *as, like, or the way*.

Look at some examples from the dialogue:

Examples:

- *I hope that your week was better than mine.*
- *I have been working hard ever since I got here.*
- *I've done everything that I've been asked to do.*
- *The people who I work with haven't been particularly helpful either.*
- *The training that I received wasn't great.*
- *You've got to offer to pitch in wherever you can.*

